

Yellow Perch

Schooling panfish over weeds and bottom transitions

Perca flavescens

Recognize it

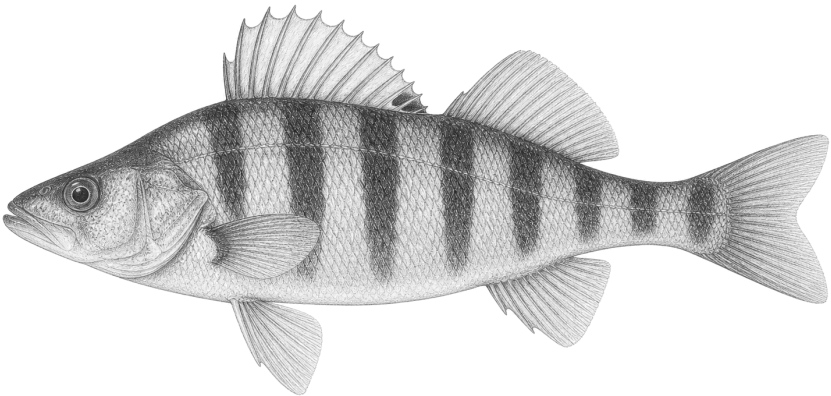
Golden fish with six to nine dark vertical bars and orange lower fins.

Body	Elongate panfish shape; two separate dorsal fins, first strongly spined.
Mouth/fins	Small toothed mouth; sharp gill-cover edge.
Confusion	Juvenile walleye is less golden, lacks orange lower fins, and has white tail tip.

Lake role

Where it belongs
Weeds, sand/gravel, flats beside depth, and winter basin edges.
Food and season
Insects, crayfish, and small fish; schools follow bottom prey and spawning routes.

Identification plate



Original graphite portrait for this ChatGPT edition. Morphology reviewed against Wisconsin DNR species references.

Find it on these waters

Pine	Test deep weed edge and firm flats; use electronics to avoid fishing beneath suspended schools.
North	Test weed-to-sand transitions, narrows, and basin-adjacent flats.
Evidence	The DNR lake records sometimes name only a broad group such as panfish. In that case this species is a candidate member, not verified individual presence. Confirm presence before targeting; treat locations as testable habitat hypotheses, not abundance findings.

Presentations

- 1. **Small jig.** Tip with worm or small plastic; maintain bottom contact with short lifts.
- 2. **Spread search.** Use a float or slow drift until a school is found, then tighten the area.
- 3. **Stop rule.** One fish may be chance; two at the same depth is a pattern. If the school leaves, search again.

HANDLING DECIDES THE OUTCOME

Fold the first dorsal back carefully and avoid the sharp gill-cover edge.

Water-specific rule	Open all year; no minimum; panfish daily bag 25 on both lakes as listed 2026-07-26.
Kitchen choice	Prefer thick mid-size perch; release unusually large females and stop when the meal is complete.
Before the trip	Open the Wisconsin DNR water-specific regulation page for WBIC 779200 (Pine) or 850800 (North). Check the exact water, species, and date; the live rule controls if this dated sheet differs.

Keep only a fish you can use

Decide before the cast. Bring ice, stop fishing when the planned meal is secured, and use the species-specific cooking guide for dispatch, bone layout, and safe preparation. Large old predators are valuable spawners and generally carry more mercury than smaller fish.

Sources checked 2026-07-26. Wisconsin DNR lake fish records (Pine WBIC 779200; North WBIC 850800), Wisconsin’s Fishes, Hook Your Catch, 2026–27 water-specific regulations, Catch-and-release Guidelines, and Eating Your Catch. Biological and tactical synthesis is editorial; it is not a current population survey.

Telos. Lake Country Fishing · ChatGPT — Yellow Perch. Revised 2026-07-26. Project-created text and diagrams are licensed CC BY 4.0. Incorporated public-domain artwork remains public domain and is credited on the plate it appears with. See LICENSE and CREDITS.md in the source. Nothing here is professional advice; verify current regulations and follow the stated safety procedure.